REPUBLIC OF THE PHILIPPINES · DEPARTMENT OF EDUCATION

Villa Antonio Elementary School

Calapan East District

USER MANUAL AND OPERATIONS GUIDE

School Information Management System

SIMS · Version 1.0

A practical guide for the School Head and teachers: enrolling learners, assigning teaching loads, encoding quarterly grades, and generating official DepEd forms — all from the school's own network.

PREPARED FOR
School Head and Faculty

PREPARED BY
Project Development Team

DOCUMENT VERSION
1.0

DATE ISSUED
October 2026

SYSTEM ENVIRONMENT
On-premise, school LAN

CLASSIFICATION
Internal — for school use

CONTENTS

What is in this manual

Chapters 1 to 4 explain the system and how access works. Chapters 5 and 6 are task-by-task guides for each role. Chapters 7 to 11 cover the rules, IT operations, data privacy, support, and known limitations.

PART I — ORIENTATION

1 About This Manual — Purpose, audience, conventions

2 System Overview — Modules, architecture, scope

3 Getting Started — Signing in, passwords, navigation

4 Roles and Permissions — Who can do what, and why

PART II — ROLE GUIDES

5 School Head Guide — Teachers, loads, monitoring, forms

6 Teacher Guide — Enrolment, grades, advisory class

PART III — REFERENCE AND OPERATIONS

7 Rules Reference — Grade computation, scoping, data rules

8 Deployment and IT Operations — Server, network, backup, updates

9 Security and Data Privacy — Accounts, audit trail, RA 10173

10 Troubleshooting and FAQ — Common problems and answers

11 Known Limitations and Roadmap — What the system does not do yet

APPENDICES

A Quick Reference Card — One-page task list per role

B Glossary — DepEd and system terms

C First-Run Checklist — Go-live steps for the School Head

DOCUMENT CONTROL

Version 1.0 · October 2026 · Initial release for client presentation. Changes to workflows, permissions, or deployment should be reflected here and the version number incremented.

CHAPTER 1

About This Manual

This manual explains how to use and operate the School Information Management System (SIMS) of Villa Antonio Elementary School. It is written for the people who will use the system every day, not for programmers.

1.1 Purpose

SIMS replaces the paper-and-spreadsheet routine of enrolment, class lists, and quarterly grade recording with one system shared by the School Head and the teaching staff. The manual is intended to:

- Give each role a clear, step-by-step guide to its daily tasks.
- Document the rules the system enforces, so results are predictable and auditable.
- Explain how the system is hosted inside the school and how it is kept safe.
- Provide a single reference for training, turnover, and future maintenance.

1.2 Who should read what

READER	READ FIRST	THEN
School Head	Chapters 2, 3, 4	Chapter 5 (daily work), Chapter 9 (privacy), Appendix C (go-live)
Teachers	Chapters 3, 4	Chapter 6 (enrolment and grades), Chapter 10 (troubleshooting)
School IT coordinator	Chapters 2, 8, 9	Chapter 10, Appendix C
Evaluators / client reviewers	Chapters 2, 4, 7, 11	Chapter 8 (deployment model), Chapter 9 (compliance)

1.3 Conventions used

Bold labels	Text that matches a button, menu item, field, or page in the system, for example **Enroll Student** or **Teaching Load**.
Numbered steps	A task to perform in order. Steps assume you are already signed in.
Callout boxes	Blue boxes contain useful context; amber boxes contain cautions; red boxes mark actions that cannot be undone; green boxes confirm expected results.
Role tags	`SCHOOL HEAD` and `TEACHER` mark which role a task belongs to.

> **A NOTE ON TERMINOLOGY**
>
> The system uses “School Head” for the administrator account and “Teacher” for faculty accounts. In the interface, the School Head may appear as **Admin** in the role badge — both refer to the same role.

1.4 Support

For account issues, data corrections, or system errors, contact the school's designated SIMS administrator or IT coordinator. Record the page you were on, the exact message shown, and the time it happened — this makes problems much faster to resolve.

CONTACT	DETAILS
School SIMS administrator	_____
IT coordinator / service provider	_____
School Head's office	_____

CHAPTER 2

System Overview

SIMS is a web application that runs on a computer inside the school. Staff open it in a browser; nothing is installed on teacher devices and nothing is stored online.

2.1 What the system does

PEOPLE

Teachers

Official faculty records, positions, and the advisory class each teacher handles.

PEOPLE

Learners

Student records with LRN, personal details, guardian contacts, and enrolment history.

OPERATIONS

Enrolment

Grade level, section, and school year per learner, with live headcounts by sex.

INSTRUCTION

Teaching Load

The subjects and sections each teacher is officially assigned to handle.

RECORDS

Grades

Quarterly ratings Q1–Q4, automatic final rating, and PASSED/FAILED remarks.

REPORTS

DepEd Forms

SF1 School Register, SF9 Progress Report Card, and SF10 Permanent Record as PDFs.

2.2 How the system is structured

The system has three parts: the interface staff see in the browser, the application that applies the rules and permissions, and the school database. All three run on a single computer inside the school.

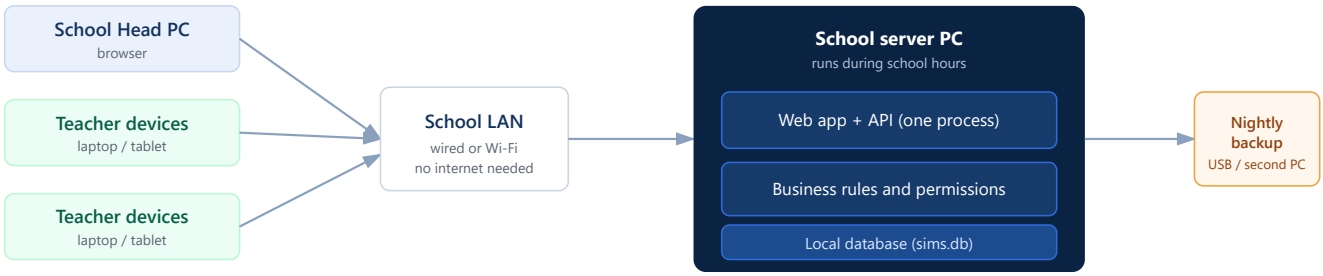


Figure 1. Deployment model — all processing and data stay inside the school.

2.3 What the system deliberately does not do

Being clear about scope prevents misaligned expectations. SIMS is a school records system, not a full learning management system. It does not handle attendance, lesson plans, learner portfolios, parent logins,

or SMS/e-mail notifications. The full list of current limitations is in Chapter 11.

> **OFFLINE BY DESIGN**
>
> Because everything runs on the school's own computer, the system keeps working even if the school's internet connection is down. It only needs the local network between staff devices and the server.

2.4 Technology summary

LAYER	TECHNOLOGY	PURPOSE
Interface	React 18 progressive web app	Browser-based screens; no installation on teacher devices.
Application	ASP.NET Core (.NET 8) Web API	Applies permissions, computes final grades, generates PDFs.
Database	SQLite (single file)	Stores all school records on the server's disk.
Reports	QuestPDF	Produces SF1, SF9, and SF10 documents.
Hosting	Windows PC on the school LAN	No subscription, no external server, no data leaves the school.

CHAPTER 3

Getting Started

Everything starts with a browser and a school account. This chapter covers signing in, changing the password, and finding your way around.

3.1 What you need

- A laptop, desktop, or tablet connected to the school network (wired or school Wi-Fi).
- A current browser — Chrome, Edge, or Firefox. Internet Explorer is not supported.
- The SIMS address from your IT coordinator, for example **http://192.168.1.50:5000**.
- The username and initial password issued by the School Head.

> **BOOKMARK IT**
>
> Save the SIMS address as a browser bookmark or add it to your desktop. The exact address is fixed per school — ask your IT coordinator if you are unsure.

3.2 Signing in

1. Open your browser and go to the SIMS address.
2. Enter your **Username** and **Password**.
3. Select **Login**.
4. The dashboard for your role opens. The sidebar on the left lists only the pages your account is allowed to use.

> **FIRST SIGN-IN**
>
> If the School Head created your account, you received an initial password. Change it immediately (next section). Until you do, the School Head still knows your credentials.

3.3 Changing your password

SCHOOL HEAD TEACHER Available to every signed-in user.

1. In the sidebar footer, select **Change Password**.
2. Enter your **current password**.
3. Enter a **new password** of at least 6 characters.
4. Enter the same password again to confirm.

5 Select **Change Password** to save.

The new password takes effect immediately. The old password stops working at once — anyone who knew it, including the School Head, can no longer sign in with it.

> **THERE IS NO SELF-SERVICE RESET**
>
> If you forget your password, you cannot recover it from the login screen. Contact the school's SIMS administrator so your password can be reset on the server. Do not share accounts or write passwords on visible notes.

3.4 Finding your way around

The left sidebar is the main navigation. Which items appear depends on your role. The header at the top of every page shows your name, the current page, and a notifications and settings icon. The footer of the sidebar holds **Change Password** and **Logout**.

PAGE	SCHOOL HEAD	WHAT IT IS FOR
Dashboard	Yes	Enrolment totals and, for the School Head, the latest activity by teachers.
Teachers	Yes	Faculty records and teacher account creation. School Head only.
Teaching Load	Yes	Which teacher handles which subject and section. School Head only.
Students	Yes	Learner records. Read-only for the School Head; teachers see their advisees.
Enrollments	Yes	Grade level, section, and school year per learner. Enrolment is done by teachers.
Grades	Yes	Quarterly ratings and final ratings. Read-only for the School Head.
DepEd Forms	Yes	Generate SF1, SF9, and SF10 PDFs.

3.5 Signing out and session length

Select **Logout** at the bottom of the sidebar, especially on a shared computer. Sessions remain valid for up to 8 hours; after that you are returned to the login screen automatically.

> **SHARED DEVICES**
>
> Always log out on a shared staff computer. Closing the browser tab is not the same as logging out — the session can stay active for the rest of the school day.

CHAPTER 4

Roles and Permissions

SIMS has two roles. Permissions are enforced by the application on every request, not just hidden in the interface, so a teacher cannot perform School Head actions by guessing a web address.

4.1 The two roles

School Head	The administrator. Maintains faculty records, creates teacher logins, defines the official teaching load, and monitors enrolment, grades, and recent activity. Has read-only access to learner data and grades — the School Head cannot encode grades.
Teacher	Faculty account. Enrols learners into their own advisory class, records grades for their advisees and for the subjects and sections formally assigned to them, and generates DepEd forms.

4.2 Permission matrix

TASK	SCHOOL HEAD	TEACHER
View the dashboard	All enrollees	Own advisory only
Add, edit, or delete teacher records	Yes	No
Create a teacher login	Yes	No
Assign teaching load (subject + section)	Yes	No
View learner records	All (read-only)	Advisees only
Enrol a learner	No	Own grade level
Edit or remove an enrolment	No	Own advisees only
Encode, edit, or delete grades	No	Advisees + assigned subject/section
Generate SF1 / SF9 / SF10	Yes	Yes
View recent activity log	Yes	No
Change own password	Yes	Yes

4.3 Advisory class versus subject teaching

A teacher has two different kinds of access, and they can hold both at the same time without conflict:

ACCESS TYPE

Advisory class

The learners the teacher enrolled and is responsible for. The teacher can edit their learner records, their enrolment, and *all* subject grades for those learners.

ACCESS TYPE

Subject teaching load

A specific subject in a specific section assigned by the School Head. The teacher can encode *only that subject* for the learners in that section.

Example: Ms. Liwanag advises Grade 2 — Tulingan and also teaches Mathematics to Grade 5 — Sampaguita. She can encode every subject for her Tulingan advisees, but only Mathematics for the Sampaguita learners. She cannot see or encode anything for Grade 4 — Shark.

4.4 What “advisory” means in practice

A teacher becomes the adviser of a class by enrolling those learners. The enrolment records the teacher who created it, and that link is what grants advisory access. This is why the School Head cannot enrol learners on a teacher's behalf: enrolment is deliberately a teacher action, and it establishes responsibility.

> **SECTION NAMES MUST MATCH EXACTLY**
>
> Teaching load and enrolment compare section names as text. “Tulingan” and “tulingan” are different sections as far as the system is concerned, and the teacher would not get access to the enrolment. Use the section suggestions shown when assigning load, and keep spelling consistent.

4.5 Separation of duties

- The School Head **creates** teacher logins but **cannot sign in as a teacher**.
- Only the account owner can change a password; the School Head cannot see new passwords after a teacher changes them.
- Only teachers encode grades; the School Head can review but not alter them.
- Deleting a teacher record also deletes that teacher's login, immediately removing access.

CHAPTER 5

School Head Guide

This chapter follows the School Head's routine, from setting up the school year to monitoring the work teachers do.

5.1 Dashboard

After signing in, the dashboard summarises the active school year: total enrollees, male and female counts, and the school year label. Below the totals, the **Recent Activity** panel lists the latest student, enrolment, and grade changes made by teachers.

- Each row shows the teacher's name, what they did, their role, and how long ago it happened.
- Select **Refresh** to load newer entries; the list is not live-updating.
- Hover over the relative time to see the exact date and time.

> **WHAT THE ACTIVITY LOG IS FOR**
>
> It is a monitoring aid, not a full audit trail: it shows the ten most recent changes. Use it to confirm that enrolment and grade entry are progressing, and to spot corrections that may need follow-up.

5.2 Managing teachers

SCHOOL HEAD

Teachers lists the faculty with name, position, advisory class, and account status. The **Advisory Class** column is derived from enrolment records, so it reflects reality rather than a separate setting.

Adding a teacher

1. Open **Teachers** and select **Add Teacher**.
2. Complete the personal and employment fields: name, gender, birth date, address, position, and marital status.
3. Set the **Assigned Grade Level** — this controls which grade level the teacher may enrol learners into.
4. Optionally list the subjects the teacher handles. This is descriptive; actual grade permissions come from Teaching Load.
5. Select **Save**.

Editing or deleting a teacher

Use the pencil icon to correct details. The trash icon deletes the teacher and, if they have a login, that login as well — the person can no longer sign in. Deletion is permanent and should only be used for staff who have left or records created in error.

5.3 Creating a teacher login

SCHOOL HEAD

1. On **Teachers**, select the key icon on the teacher's row.
2. Enter a **username** (for example `juan.delacruz`) and an **initial password**.
3. Select **Create Login**.
4. Hand the credentials to the teacher in person. Ask them to change the password on first sign-in.

> **YOU WILL NOT KNOW THE FINAL PASSWORD**
>
> Once the teacher changes their password through **Change Password**, the initial password stops working. This is intentional: it protects teacher accounts and keeps the School Head out of individual logins.

5.4 Assigning teaching load

SCHOOL HEAD

Teaching Load is the single source of truth for what each teacher may encode. A teacher can only record grades for the exact subject and section pairs assigned here.

1. Open **Teaching Load** and select **Assign Subject**.
2. Choose the **teacher**.
3. Choose the **subject**. Subjects are grouped by grade level, because a subject belongs to one grade.
4. Enter the **section**. Use the suggested sections from existing enrolments whenever possible.
5. Select **Save**.

The table lists every assignment with the teacher, grade level, subject, section, and school year. The trash icon removes an assignment; the change takes effect immediately, so a teacher loses encoding rights for that subject the next time they load the page.

> **MID-YEAR CHANGES**
>
> When a teacher takes over a subject or section, add the new assignment. When they hand it over, remove the old one. There is no need to wait for a new school year; access follows the current load.

5.5 Students

SCHOOL HEAD

Students is a read-only directory of learner records: LRN, name, gender, birth date, and grade level. Use the search box for a name or LRN, and the grade-level dropdown to narrow the list. Select **View** on a row to see guardian details, address, previous school, and enrolment status.

5.6 Enrollments

SCHOOL HEAD

Enrollments shows every learner's grade level, section, school year, and enrolment date. It is read-only for the School Head — enrolment is a teacher responsibility, and the enrolment record establishes which teacher is the adviser. Use this page to verify section assignments and spot duplicates.

5.7 Grades

SCHOOL HEAD

Grades groups learners by grade level. Expand a grade level to see its learners, then select a learner to view every subject's quarterly ratings, final rating, and remarks. The School Head cannot edit grades; corrections must be made by the teacher who owns the class.

5.8 DepEd Forms

SCHOOL HEAD TEACHER

The generator produces official PDFs from the records already in the system. Choose a form card, set the options, then select **Generate PDF**; the file is downloaded to your device.

FORM	PURPOSE	REQUIRED SELECTION
SF1	School Register — master list of enrolled learners	Grade level, or leave empty for all grades
SF9	Progress Report Card — quarterly grades per learner	One learner
SF10	Permanent Record — academic history per learner	One learner

> **GENERATE FROM COMPLETE DATA**
>
> Forms reflect what is recorded. Generate SF9 only after grades are encoded, and confirm the learner's enrolment before generating SF1 or SF10.

CHAPTER 6

Teacher Guide

A teacher's work runs from enrolment at the start of the year to grades and report cards at the end of each quarter. This chapter covers each step.

6.1 What you will see

Teachers see five pages: **Dashboard**, **Students**, **Enrollments**, **Grades**, and **DepEd Forms**. The dashboard counts only your own advisory class, and the learner lists are limited to your advisees — you will not see other teachers' classes.

6.2 Enrolling a learner

TEACHER

Enrolment is how a learner becomes part of your advisory class. Do this before encoding any grade.

1. Open **Enrollments** and select **Enroll Student**.
2. Enter the learner's **LRN**, name, sex, and birth date.
3. Add the address, parent or guardian name and contact number, and previous school (use “N/A” if not applicable).
4. Confirm the **Grade Level** — it defaults to your assigned grade level and the system will reject a different one.
5. Enter the **Section**. Use the section name agreed with the School Head.
6. Select **Save Enrollment**.

> **EXPECTED RESULT**
>
> The learner appears immediately in Enrollments, Students, and your Grades class list. No refresh or sign-out is needed.

> **RECORDS ARE UNIQUE**
>
> The system rejects a duplicate LRN, and rejects a second enrolment of the same learner in the same school year. If a learner transferred or was enrolled in error, edit or delete the existing enrolment instead of creating a new one.

Correcting an enrolment

On the Enrollments page, your own advisees have **Edit** and **Delete** buttons. Edit corrects the learner details, grade level, or section. Delete removes the enrolment together with the learner record — it is permanent, so verify the row before confirming.

6.3 Recording grades

TEACHER

Finding a learner

1. Open **Grades**. **My Classes** lists your advisory class and each subject-section you teach.
2. Select a class to expand its roster.
3. Select the learner. The grade panel opens on the right.

Encoding a new grade

1. Select **Add Grade**.
2. If you are in an advisory class, choose the **Subject**. If the class is a subject load, the subject is fixed.
3. Type the quarterly ratings in **Q1** to **Q4**. Enter whole numbers from 60 to 100; leave a quarter blank if it is not yet available.
4. Select **Save**.

When all four quarters are present, the system computes the final rating as their average and sets the remarks automatically. Until then, the final column shows a dash.

Editing or deleting a grade

Select the pencil icon on the grade row, change the quarter values, then select the check icon to save. The cross icon cancels the edit. To remove a grade entirely, use the delete icon on the row and confirm.

> **YOU CAN ONLY CHANGE YOUR OWN SUBJECTS**
>
> If you teach Mathematics to a section, you cannot see or edit its English grades — those belong to the subject teacher or the adviser. If a subject is missing from the Add Grade list, ask the School Head to check your Teaching Load.

6.4 Advisory class and subject loads in the class list

The class list labels each entry. **Advisory** is your own class, where every subject is open to you. A subject name, such as **Mathematics**, is a section you teach for that subject only.

CLASS ENTRY	WHAT YOU CAN DO
Advisory — Grade 1, Dolphin	Edit advisee records, enrolment, and grades for all subjects.
Mathematics — Grade 5, Sampaguita	Encode Mathematics grades only; learner records are read-only.

6.5 Generating DepEd forms

Open **DepEd Forms**, choose SF1, SF9, or SF10, make the required selection, then select **Generate PDF**. For SF9 and SF10 the learner dropdown lists the learners you are allowed to see. See section 5.8 for the form reference.

6.6 Your students page

Students is a read-only view of your advisees with search. To change any detail, including address or guardian contact, use **Enrollments** → **Edit** on the learner's row. Learners from other classes will not appear here.

CHAPTER 7

Rules Reference

These are the rules the system applies automatically. Knowing them prevents most support questions.

7.1 Grade rules

RULE	BEHAVIOUR
Quarterly rating range	Whole numbers from **60 to 100**. Values outside this range, or with decimals, are rejected.
Final rating	Average of Q1, Q2, Q3, and Q4, computed automatically once all four are present.
Passing mark	**75 or above** — remarks show **PASSED**. Below 75 shows **FAILED**.
Partial entries	Allowed. Quarters can be saved one at a time; the final rating stays blank until the fourth quarter is entered.
One grade per subject	A learner cannot have two grade records for the same subject. Edit the existing record instead.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Q1 85, Q2 88, Q3 90, Q4 92 → final rating **88.75**, remarks **PASSED**. Q1 70, Q2 72, Q3 74, Q4 76 → final **73**, remarks **FAILED**.

7.2 Enrolment rules

RULE	BEHAVIOUR
Grade level	A teacher may only enrol into their own assigned grade level.
Unique LRN	An LRN can exist only once in the learner registry.
One enrolment per year	The same learner cannot be enrolled twice in the same school year.
Adviser link	The teacher who creates the enrolment becomes the adviser of that learner.
Immediate visibility	New learners appear at once in Enrollments, Students, and the teacher's Grades class list.

7.3 Access scoping

SCREEN	TEACHER SEES
Students	Own advisees only.
Enrollments	Own advisees only.
Grades	Own advisees, plus the subject-section pairs assigned in Teaching Load.
Dashboard	Counts for the advisory class only.

7.4 School year behaviour

The system works within one active school year at a time, currently **2026–2027**. The enrolment form records the active year, and grade records belong to the learner's enrolment for that year. For a new school year, the active year must be updated by the system administrator before enrolment begins.

> **BEFORE A NEW SCHOOL YEAR**
>
> Ask the system administrator to set the new active school year and verify the enrolment form shows it. Enrolments created under the wrong year will need to be corrected individually.

7.5 Data rules at a glance

UNIQUENESS

LRN

One learner record per LRN across the whole school.

UNIQUENESS

Teaching load

The same teacher, subject, section, and year cannot be assigned twice.

UNIQUENESS

Subject grade

One grade record per learner per subject.

CHAPTER 8

Deployment and IT Operations

This chapter is for the person who maintains the system at school. It describes the on-premise setup, the backup routine, and how to apply updates.

8.1 Deployment model

SIMS is hosted on one Windows computer at school — the "server PC". That PC serves the web interface and the API, and holds the database file. Staff devices reach it through the school network; no internet connection is required and no data is sent outside the school.

REQUIREMENT	RECOMMENDED
Server PC	Windows 10 or 11, 4 GB RAM or more, 10 GB free disk, wired network preferred.
Power	UPS strongly recommended; enable BIOS "restore on AC power loss".
Network	Fixed LAN address via DHCP reservation, for example 192.168.1.50.
Port	One TCP port for the web app, for example 5000, allowed on the Private firewall profile only.
Startup	Run at system startup through Task Scheduler, with restart on failure.

8.2 First-time setup outline

1. Prepare the server PC: fixed address, no sleep or hibernation, power settings set to stay on.
2. Publish the application to a fixed folder on the server, for example `C:\VAES-SIMS\app`.
3. Place the database in a separate data folder, for example `C:\VAES-SIMS\data\sims.db`, and configure the application to use that absolute path.
4. Set a unique application signing key for the installation; never keep the sample value.
5. Create a firewall rule allowing the web port on the private network only.
6. Register the application to start automatically at boot and survive a crash.
7. From a teacher device, open the server address in a browser and complete one full test: log in, enrol a test learner, encode a grade, generate a form.
8. Remove the test learner and the sample accounts before real data entry begins.

8.3 Daily operation

- Leave the server PC powered on during school hours; it may be shut down after the last user logs out.

- Staff access the system through the bookmarked address; nothing needs to be installed on their devices.
- If the server restarts, users simply reload the page and sign in again.

8.4 Backup and restore

The database is a single file. Because it is the only copy of the school's records, a nightly off-machine backup is mandatory.

ITEM	STANDARD
Frequency	Every school day, after the last user logs out.
Method	Consistent online backup of the database (not a simple file copy while the system is running), written to a USB drive or a second PC on the LAN.
Retention	At least 30 daily copies; keep one copy per month for the school year.
Verification	Test a restore once before go-live and at least once per quarter.
Custody	Backups contain personal data; store them locked, and record who holds them.

> **AN UNTESTED BACKUP IS NOT A BACKUP**
>
> Restore a recent copy into a test folder and confirm the data opens. Do this before the system holds a full year of grades, not after.

8.5 Applying updates

1. Back up the database first.
2. Publish the new build to a fresh folder.
3. Stop the running application, switch the startup path to the new folder, and start it.
4. Sign in and spot-check enrolment, grades, and one PDF.
5. Keep the previous build folder until the new one is confirmed working.

8.6 Network and access notes

- The system is reachable only from the school network. There is no remote access from home.
- Give teacher devices the wired network or the staff Wi-Fi; guest Wi-Fi networks that isolate clients will not reach the server.
- The web address uses plain HTTP on the local network. Browsers may warn that the connection is not private; this is expected for a LAN-only address.
- Installing the app as a home-screen or desktop application requires HTTPS; on plain HTTP it works as a normal website.

CHAPTER 9

Security and Data Privacy

Learner records are personal data. The system applies access control and keeps data inside the school, but compliance also depends on how accounts and backups are handled day to day.

9.1 Built-in protections

CONTROL	HOW IT WORKS
Authentication	Every page and every API request requires a signed-in session. Sessions expire after 8 hours.
Role-based access	The server re-checks permission on each request, so hidden buttons cannot be bypassed by editing the address.
Data scoping	Teachers are limited to their advisees and their assigned subject-sections.
Separation of duties	The School Head cannot log in as a teacher or alter grades; teachers cannot change teaching loads.
Password ownership	Only the account owner can change a password after the initial issue.
Access withdrawal	Deleting a teacher record deletes the linked login in the same action.
Activity log	Student, enrolment, and grade changes are recorded with the actor, action, and time.
Local storage	Data never leaves the school server; there is no cloud copy.

9.2 Account hygiene

- One account per person. Never share a login, even between teachers who job-share.
- Change the initial password on first sign-in; use at least 8 characters with a mix of letters and numbers.
- Disable access the same day a teacher leaves or transfers: delete the teacher record, which also removes the login.
- The School Head's account is the highest privilege in the system — protect it and change its default password immediately.

9.3 Data Privacy Act (RA 10173) considerations

Schools processing learner information are personal information controllers. The on-premise design supports the following obligations:

PRINCIPLE	HOW SIMS SUPPORTS IT
Purpose limitation	Only enrolment, learner identity, guardian contact, and grades are collected — the data needed for school records.
Access control	Role-based permissions and advisory scoping limit each user to the learners they work with.
Accountability	The activity log records who made each student, enrolment, and grade change.
Storage limitation	Data stays on school equipment under school custody.
Security	Server kept in a controlled area; backups encrypted or physically secured; no public exposure.

> **OPERATIONAL PRACTICES THAT REMAIN THE SCHOOL'S RESPONSIBILITY**
>
> A written privacy notice for parents, a retention and disposal schedule, a breach response procedure, and designating a data protection officer are school-level obligations. The system provides the controls; the school must document their use.

9.4 Known security limitations

- Passwords are stored as unsalted hashes. This is acceptable for a closed school LAN in the pilot phase, but should be upgraded before wider deployment or internet exposure.
- There is no administrator password reset screen; recovery is done by the system administrator on the server.
- The activity log keeps recent entries for monitoring and is not a tamper-proof audit ledger.
- Plain HTTP on the LAN means traffic is not encrypted between devices and the server.
- There is no automatic account lockout after repeated failed logins.

CHAPTER 10

Troubleshooting and FAQ

Most issues fall into a few patterns. Work through the relevant table before contacting support.

10.1 Common problems

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE	WHAT TO DO
The page will not load at all	Server PC off, wrong address, or not on the school network	Check that the server PC is on and connected; confirm the address with your IT coordinator; reconnect to the school network.
“Invalid credentials”	Username typo or the password has been changed	Re-type carefully, check capitalisation, and ask the SIMS administrator for a reset if needed.
Signed out unexpectedly	The 8-hour session expired or the server restarted	Sign in again. Unsaved form entries will be lost.
No students appear for a teacher	The teacher has no advisory class yet	The teacher must enrol their learners. Advisory is established by enrolment, not by the teacher record.
“Add Grade” is missing a subject	No matching teaching load, or the subject is not offered for that grade	Ask the School Head to check Teaching Load for that exact subject, section, and school year.
A grade is refused	Value below 60, above 100, or not a whole number	Enter a whole number from 60 to 100.
Final rating shows “—”	Not all four quarters are entered	Complete Q1 to Q4; the final rating appears automatically.
“You can only enroll students in Grade X”	The selected grade level differs from the teacher's assigned grade level	Use the teacher's assigned grade level, or ask the School Head to correct the teacher record.
“LRN already exists”	The learner is already registered	Search Students for the LRN and edit the existing record instead of creating a duplicate.
“Student already enrolled for this school year”	A second enrolment was attempted	Edit the existing enrolment on the Enrollments page.

SYMPTOM	LIKELY CAUSE	WHAT TO DO
PDF generation fails or downloads an empty file	Missing data, or a font problem on the server	Confirm the learner is enrolled and grades exist. If it persists, report it to the IT coordinator with the form type and learner.
Browser warns “Not secure”	The site uses plain HTTP on the school LAN	Expected for an internal address. Do not enter SIMS credentials on any other site.
“Install app” is not offered	PWA installation requires HTTPS	Use the site in the browser and bookmark it instead.

10.2 Frequently asked questions

Can the School Head see or reset a teacher's password?

No. The School Head issues the initial password; after the teacher changes it, only the teacher knows it. If it is forgotten, the system administrator resets it on the server and hands over a new initial password.

Can the School Head enter grades for a teacher who is absent?

No. Grade entry is restricted to the teacher who owns the class. The School Head can review grades but must ask the teacher — or the system administrator for an exceptional correction.

Why does a teacher see only a few students?

Teachers see their advisory class only. If a teacher should have more learners, check that those learners are enrolled under that teacher and that the section spelling matches the teaching load.

What happens when a learner transfers out?

The adviser deletes the enrolment, which also removes the learner record. If the learner may return, confirm the school's records retention policy first.

Can several teachers use the system at the same time?

Yes. The database handles the normal load of a school's staff. Users may occasionally wait a fraction of a second while another user's save completes.

Does the system work if the internet is down?

Yes, provided the server PC and the school's local network are running. Internet is not used for day-to-day operation.

How often should we back up?

Every school day, to a device that is not the server PC. Test a restore quarterly.

Where can teachers work from?

Anywhere inside the school network. There is no access from home.

CHAPTER 11

Known Limitations and Roadmap

The system is ready for daily school operations. The following items are known and deliberately out of scope for version 1.0.

11.1 Current limitations

AREA	LIMITATION AND WORKAROUND
School year rollover	The active school year must be changed by the system administrator; there is no in-app year management screen.
Section naming	Sections are free text. Typos break teaching-load matching, so follow the suggested section list.
Password recovery	No self-service or School Head reset; recovery is done on the server by IT.
Password storage	Unsalted hashes; upgrade recommended before external exposure.
PWA installation	Requires HTTPS; on the LAN the system runs as a normal website.
Audit log depth	The dashboard shows the most recent ten activities; there is no exportable audit report.
Remote access	Not available by design; the system is LAN-only.
Multiple schools	One school per installation.
Bulk data	No CSV or Excel import/export; records are entered through the screens.

11.2 Not included in version 1.0

- Attendance tracking and daily logs.
- Parent or learner portal access.
- Class schedules and lesson plans.
- Learning materials, document uploads, and learner photos.
- Analytics dashboards and comparative reports.
- SMS or e-mail notifications.
- Weighted or DepEd-specific grading formulas beyond the quarterly average.

11.3 Recommended next steps

1. Run a full school-year pilot with real enrolment, grades, and forms.
2. Upgrade password storage and add an administrator password reset before wider use.
3. Add an exportable audit and grade summary for School Head reporting.
4. Add school-year management so rollover does not need technical support.
5. Evaluate an internal HTTPS certificate if app-style installation becomes a requirement.

APPENDIX A

Quick Reference Card

A.1 School Head — daily and periodic tasks

WHEN	TASK
Start of year	Add teachers → create logins → hand over initial passwords → assign teaching loads.
During enrolment	Monitor the dashboard totals and Recent Activity; verify sections on Enrollments.
Each quarter	Review grades by grade level; confirm teachers have completed Q1–Q4.
Report card period	Generate SF9 per learner and SF1 for the register; archive the PDFs.
Staff changes	Delete the departing teacher (removes the login) and reassign their load.
Daily	Confirm the backup ran; keep the USB copy in a secured place.

A.2 Teacher — start of year

1. Sign in and change the initial password.
2. Open Enrollments and enrol each learner in your advisory class.
3. Verify the learners appear in Students and in your Grades class list.
4. Check My Classes — you should see your advisory class and any subject loads.

A.3 Teacher — each quarter

1. Open Grades and select the class.
2. Select a learner, choose Add Grade (or edit the existing row).
3. Enter whole numbers 60–100 for the quarter.
4. Confirm the final rating and remarks once all four quarters are complete.
5. Generate SF9 when the School Head requests report cards.

A.4 Keyboard and UI tips

- Use the search box on every list page instead of scrolling long tables.
- Tables scroll sideways on small screens; scroll the table, not the page, to reach the Actions column.
- Hover over relative times in Recent Activity to see the exact timestamp.
- Always log out on shared computers.

APPENDIX B

Glossary

Advisory class	The group of learners a teacher enrolled and is responsible for. Grants full grade access to those learners.
Final rating	The average of the four quarterly ratings, computed automatically once all four are present.
LRN	Learner Reference Number — the unique identifier issued to each learner.
PASSED / FAILED	Remarks derived from the final rating: 75 or above is PASSED.
Q1–Q4	First to fourth quarter ratings, whole numbers from 60 to 100.
School Head	The administrator role. Manages teachers, loads, and monitoring; read-only on learner data and grades.
School year	The academic year the records belong to, for example 2026–2027.
Section	The class group within a grade level, for example “Dolphin”. Compared as exact text across modules.
SF1	School Register — the master list of enrolled learners.
SF9	Learner's Progress Report Card, formerly Form 138.
SF10	Learner's Permanent Academic Record, formerly Form 137.
Teaching load	The subject-and-section pairs assigned to a teacher. Determines which grades the teacher may encode.
Teacher	Faculty role. Enrols advisees and encodes grades for advisees and assigned subject-sections.

APPENDIX C

First-Run Checklist

Complete these items before teachers begin entering real data. Each item should be ticked off and dated by the School Head or IT coordinator.

#	ITEM	DONE
1	Server PC placed in a secured area, connected by wired LAN, with a fixed address.	☐
2	Power settings: no sleep, BIOS restore-on-power-loss enabled, UPS connected if available.	☐
3	Application starts automatically at boot and restarts after a crash.	☐
4	Firewall allows the web port on the private network only.	☐
5	A unique application signing key is set for this installation.	☐
6	Default and demo accounts removed; the School Head password changed.	☐
7	Test learners and test grades removed from the live database.	☐
8	Real teacher records created and one login issued per teacher.	☐
9	Teaching loads assigned for the current school year, with section names matching enrolments.	☐
10	Nightly backup scheduled to a USB drive or second PC; first backup verified.	☐
11	Restore test completed successfully into a separate folder.	☐
12	End-to-end test on a teacher device: sign in, enrol a test learner, encode a grade, generate SF9, then remove the test data.	☐
13	Staff briefing conducted: signing in, changing password, enrolling, encoding grades, logging out.	☐
14	Support contacts recorded and posted in the faculty room.	☐

SIGN-OFF

School Head: _____ Date: _____
IT Coordinator: _____ Date: _____